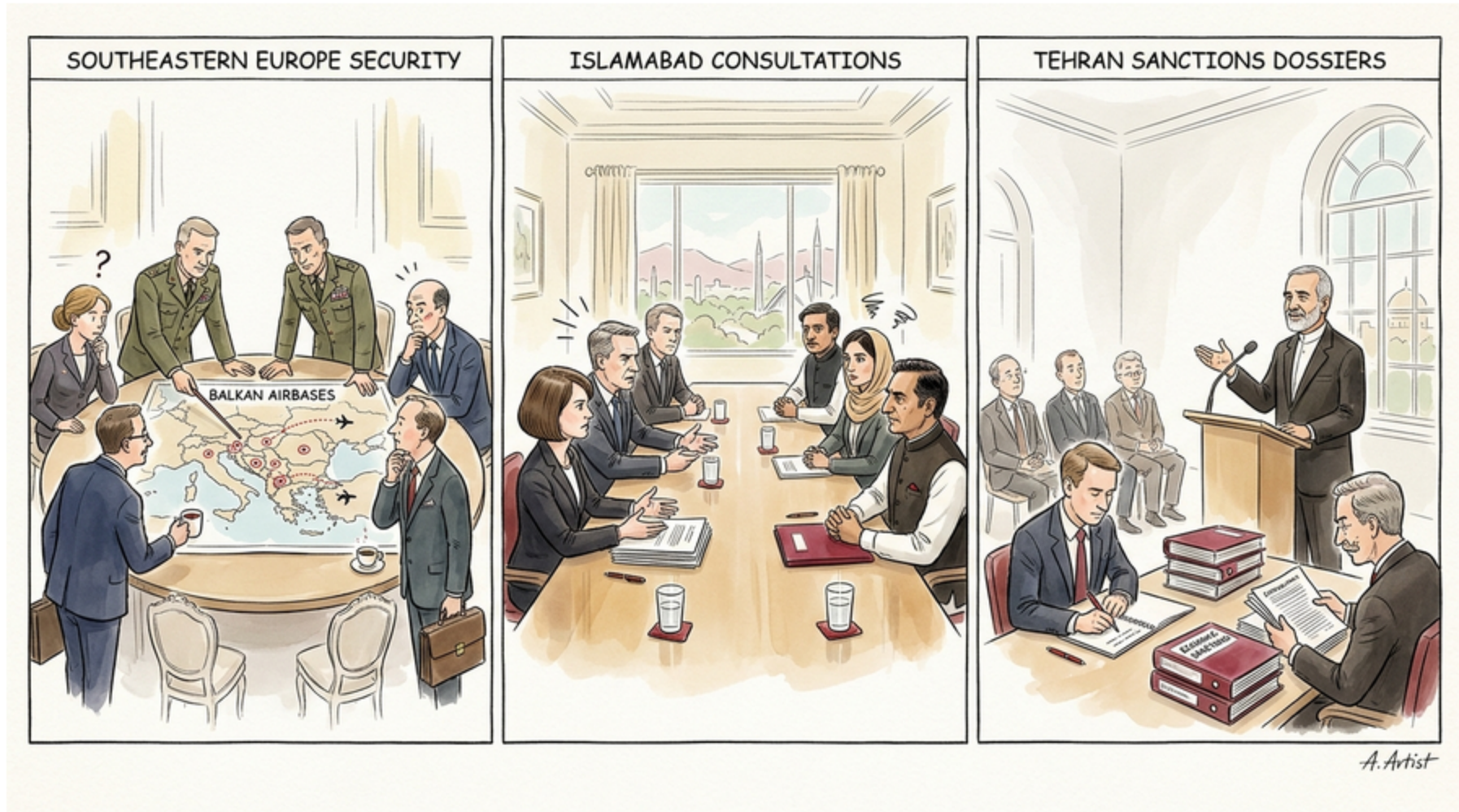


Strategic Brief

August 22, 2026



Iran Threatens NATO's Southeast Flank as War Nears Europe, US-Pakistan Spat Erupts Over Kashmir Visit

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The Bottom Line

The Iran-US war is entering a new phase: Tehran is threatening NATO's European flank even as both sides signal openness to ending the conflict, with Washington pivoting to a sanctions campaign and Iran insisting it negotiates from strength. The US re-designation of Hezbollah as an Iranian proxy widens the legal and financial front, while a Trump envoy's Kashmir remarks strain US-Pakistan ties and Bangladesh holds its first contested presidential vote in decades. The central question is whether the war can be contained to the Middle East or whether Europe's southeast becomes the next front.

Read the full analysis at frontion.news